

THE HOME OFFICE

Creative Desk Options

A funky old farm table with a comfy chair, a core door on top of some old filing cabinets, or a piece of plywood attached to a couple of sawhorses and painted black are all ways I've seen work-at-home desks done on the cheap.

Rubber Stamps

Skip the special-order address labels and save yourself the individual addressing time by picking up a return-address rubber stamp for your home office. Reusable, affordable, and simple.

Supplies

It's easy to go overboard on nice office supplies. Turn boxes inside out and re-tape for shipping. Wait for deals and rebates from the larger box office stores (and check their clearance boxes). When it comes to reusable items, you may have better luck at the thrift store than you think. Binders, clipboards, and desk organizers are all items I've found through those sources before.

THE YARD, PATIO, AND GARDEN

Composting

Save on potting soil and create your own "green gold" by trying your

hand at composting. There are many options depending on the size of your yard, amount of trash you can use for composting, and your level of comfort. By reusing your trash, you reduce the amount you're contributing to the landfills.

Consider Rustic or Artsy

I'm referring to your landscaping style here. Twig arbors or DIY mosaic stepping-stones are all fun projects the entire family can enjoy participating in. It's also much easier to take your time with these designs and still have your yard looking kept up with a simple mow. Think rock accents and mossy walkways with wildflower accents.

Plant Functionally

A large tree will not only provide you with a comfortable shady spot to sit, but it can also lower energy costs inside the home. Plant greens that you like to eat, like herbs, fruit, and nuts. You'll have one less thing on your grocery list. — **Myscha Theriault**

